

Choosing a gaming laptop

General guidance for shoppers in India. Not specific to any one product; always check the exact configuration and current price before buying.

The graphics card comes first

For gaming, the dedicated graphics card (GPU) matters most. In NVIDIA's RTX line, a higher number is generally faster within a generation: an RTX 4060 is faster than an RTX 4050, which is faster than an RTX 3050 class card. Integrated graphics inside the processor are fine for light games but not for modern titles at good settings. Check the video memory (VRAM): 4 GB is limiting, 6 to 8 GB suits most current games at 1080p, and more helps at higher resolutions.

Power limits change performance

The same GPU name can perform differently in different laptops because manufacturers set different power limits, often listed as TGP in watts. Thicker laptops with better cooling can run the GPU at a higher power and therefore faster. Reviews and owner reports about cooling and sustained performance are as important as the spec sheet.

Cooling and noise

Gaming laptops generate a lot of heat. Good cooling means higher sustained speeds and a longer life, but it usually means a larger, heavier body and louder fans. Owner comments about temperatures, fan noise and keyboard heat are worth reading.

Display and the rest

Look for a 120 Hz or faster screen. A QHD screen looks sharper but needs a stronger GPU to hold the same frame rate. 16 GB RAM is the practical target and 512 GB to 1 TB storage is advised because games are large. A good keyboard, enough ports (HDMI, USB-C, Ethernet) and sensible upgradability add real value.

Trade-offs to expect

Gaming laptops are heavier, have short battery life away from the charger, and cost more than ordinary laptops of similar CPU power. If you also need a portable laptop for college or travel, a thinner performance laptop with a mid-range GPU can be a better compromise than a large gaming machine. Budget gaming laptops with an entry-level GPU are fine for esports and older titles but will struggle with the newest games at high settings.